

WEAPONS, UNIFORMS, AND KIT OF THE AMERICAN REVOLUTION

At the Continental Congress, in June 1775, the 13 American colonies in revolt against British rule decided to form an army under the command of General George Washington. Initially made up of New England militiamen and rifleman volunteers, this Continental Army was later recruited on a quota basis from the 13 states. On the opposite page, the Continental Army uniform is that of the 4th Maryland Independent Company, formed in January 1776. A significant number of Americans joined up to fight alongside the British. Some Loyalists formed British regiments, while others fought in irregular militias. The uniform shown here is that of the Queen's Rangers, a Loyalist regiment established in 1776, in New York.

White and green plume of Light Company of Queen's Rangers, with black cockade beneath

Crescent emblem

▲ QUEEN'S RANGERS PLUMED CAP

Date 1776

Origin US

Material Leather, feather

The Queen's Rangers were named in honour of George III's wife, Queen Caroline. Their leather cap bore the black cockade of the royal house of Hanover.

► QUEEN'S RANGERS JACKET AND TROUSERS

Date 1776

Origin US

Material Linen, canvas

This Loyalist regiment was the first in the British Army to wear green uniforms for the purpose of camouflage. The short green jacket was known as a "round jacket".

Ruffled linen shirt with black neck stock



CARTRIDGE BOX



KNAPSACK

▲ QUEEN'S RANGERS KNAPSACK AND CARTRIDGE BOX

Date 1776

Origin US

Material Canvas, leather

Both the knapsack and the cartridge box bear an image of George III's crown. The brass badge on the cartridge box has the initials GR (George Rex).



White canvas breeches, worn with half-garters